Here are the steps to complete this lab:

14.14.4.1 Step 1: Create a New Laravel 12 Project

Open your terminal and create a new Laravel project:

```
laravel new auth-api
cd auth-api
code .
```

You should see the Laravel project structure in your code editor.

14.14.4.2 Step 2: Configure the Database Connection

Open the `.env` file and configure the MySQL connection:

```
DB_CONNECTION=mysql
DB_HOST=127.0.0.1
DB_PORT=3306
DB_DATABASE=authdb
DB_USERNAME=root
DB_PASSWORD=yourpassword
```

Change the **database name**, **username**, and **password** as needed.

Run the following command to apply the database configuration:

```
php artisan config:clear
```

14.14.4.3 Step 3: Enable API Support in Laravel 12

Laravel 12 **does not enable API routing by default**. Activate API support by running:

```
php artisan install:api
```

This command:

✔ Creates the `routes/api.php` file
✔ Configures **middleware** for API authentication
✔ Installs Laravel Sanctum for **API security**

When you run the command, you may asked to perform migraations. You can skip it for now. Type `no` and press `Enter`. We will run the migrations later.

14.14.4.4 Step 4: Install Laravel Sanctum